🌮 Protein & Main Dishes: Reading · ANSWER KEY

Culinary 1 · Unit 12 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Protein labs and end-of-semester labs (Taco through Finals Cleaning Day)

Name: _____

Protein Labs and Cleaning Up

The last labs of the semester are main dishes with protein: tacos, chili with cornbread, chicken Caesar wraps and a two-day lasagna with breadsticks, plus a fruit pizza, a fridge cleanout and a finals cleaning day.

Meat must be cooked to a safe inside temperature. Ground beef for tacos, chili and lasagna is cooked to 155°F and is brown all the way through; drain the extra fat. Chicken for the Caesar wraps is cooked to 165°F. Use a food thermometer in the thickest part.

Raw meat carries germs, so prevent cross-contamination. Use a separate cutting board for raw chicken, wash your hands after touching it, and never put cooked food back on the plate that held raw meat.

Some recipes take two days. On Day 1 of the lasagna lab you make the sauce and layer the noodles, ricotta and mozzarella, then cover it and refrigerate it. On Day 2 you bake it until hot (165°F in the center) and make breadsticks. Cornbread is a quick bread made with the muffin method.

At the end of the semester the kitchen gets cleaned. In the fridge cleanout, check dates and throw out anything old, moldy or open too long, then cook something from what is left. Use FIFO, First In, First Out: older food goes in front so it is used first. On cleaning day, clean, then sanitize every surface.

Check your reading

1. What temperatures do ground beef and chicken need to reach?
Ground beef 155°F; chicken 165°F.

2. How do you prevent cross-contamination with raw chicken?
Separate cutting board, wash hands, don't reuse the raw-meat plate.

3. What does FIFO mean?
First In, First Out: use older food first.